December 5, 1962
Interim Revision of
Fed. Spec. JJJ-A-711d
October 1, 1957

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

ASPARAGUS, CANNED

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Agricultural Marketing Services, U. S. Department of Agriculture, Washington 25, D. C., based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized Federal agencies to use this Interim Federal Specification as a valid exception to Federal Specification JJJ-A-711d.

1. CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Styles and types of pack. - Unless otherwise specified, canned asparagus shall be "unpeeled" and shall be of the following styles and applicable types of pack as specified (see 6.1):

Style I. - Spears (or stalks)
- (a) Green
- (b) Green-tipped and white

Style II. - Tips
- (a) Green
- (b) Green-tipped and white

Style III. - Points
- (a) Green
- (b) Green-tipped and white

Style IV. - Cut spears (or cut stalks)
(If cut in lengths of 1-1/4 inches or less, the product shall contain an average of not less than 15 percent, by count, of heads; if cut in length of more than 1-1/4 inches, the product shall contain an average of not less than 20 percent, by count, of heads.)
- (a) Green
- (b) Green-tipped and white

FSC 8915 and 8940

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

1.1.1 Dietetic packs. - If dietetic packs of any of the styles and applicable types are desired, canned asparagus shall be specified as "dietetic" packs together with appropriate qualifications. (See 6.1.)

1.2 Size of spears, tips, and points. - Canned asparagus of these styles shall be of the following single size or blended sizes as specified (see 6.1).

1.2.1 Singles sizes:
Small - approximately 6/16 inch diameter.
Medium - 6/16 inch to 8/16 inch diameter.
Large - 8/16 inch to 10/16 inch diameter.
Extra large (or Mammoth) - 10/16 inch to 13/16 inch diameter.
Collossal - 13/16 inch to 1 inch in diameter.
Giant - 1 inch and over in diameter.

1.2.2 Blend of sizes.

1.2.2.1 A mixture of two adjacent single sizes as specified.

1.2.2.2 A mixture of three adjacent single sizes as specified.

1.3 Grades. - Canned asparagus shall be of the following grades, as specified (see 6.1):

Fancy (Grade A)
Standard (Grade C)

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids form a part of this specification.

Federal Specifications:
PPP-C-29 - Canned Subsistence Items, Packaging and Packing of.

Federal Standards:
Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(FOR INSTRUCTIONS ON OBTAINING COPIES OF FEDERAL SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS, SEE LAST PAGE.)

Military Specifications:
MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items.

Military Standards:
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring agency or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. - The following publications, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Governmental:

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations for Its Enforcement.

(Copies of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations for Its Enforcement may be obtained upon application, accompanied by money order, coupon, or cash, to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C. Prices may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents.)

United States Standards for Grades of Canned Asparagus.
Regulations Governing Condition Inspection Procedures--Containers

(Single copies of the documents listed above may be obtained without charge from the U. S. Department of Agriculture, Washington 25, D. C.)

Nongovernmental:

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists.

(Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists is published by the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists, P. O. Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington 4, D. C.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. - Canned asparagus shall be prepared from clean, sound, succulent asparagus and, unless specified otherwise, shall be of the latest season's pack.

3.2 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. - All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, and regulations promulgated thereunder.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3 Drained weight. - Drained weights of canned asparagus shall average not less than the drained weights specified in tables I, II, and III for the applicable styles and in accordance with 4.2.4.

Table I. - Minimum drained weight for style I, spears (or stalks)

Container size or designation (metal, unless otherwise stated)	Style I, spears (or stalks)			
	Small, medium, large sizes, and blends of these sizes		Extra large, colossal, giant, or any blends including these sizes	
	(a) Green	(b) Green tipped and white	(a) Green	(b) Green tipped and white
	Ounces	Ounces	Ounces	Ounces
12 Z----------	7-1/2	8	7-1/4	7-3/4
13-1/2 Z glass--	8	8-3/4	7-1/2	8-1/4
No. 300--------	8-3/4	9-1/2	8	9
No. 300 x 409---	9	9-3/4	8-1/4	9-1/4
No. 300 cylinder	11	------	10-1/2	------
No. 1 tall	9-3/4	10-3/4	9-1/4	10-1/2
No. 303--------	9-3/4	10-3/4	9-1/4	10-1/2
No. 303 glass---	9-3/4	10-3/4	9-1/4	10-1/2
No. 2----------	12-1/4	13-1/2	11-3/4	12-3/4
No. 2-1/2------	17-3/4	19-1/2	17-1/4	18-1/2
No. 2-1/2 glass-	17-1/2	19-1/4	17	18-1/4
No. 603 x 408---	39	43	38	41

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Table II. - Minimum drained weight for style II, tips; style III, points

Container size or designation (metal, unless otherwise stated)	Style II, tips; style III, points			
	Small, medium, large sizes, and blends of these sizes		Extra large, colossal, giant, or any blend including these sizes	
	(a) Green	(b) Green tipped and white	(a) Green	(b) Green tipped and white
	Ounces	Ounces	Ounces	Ounces
8 oz. tall------	5	5-1/4	5	5-1/4
8 oz. glass-----	5	5-1/4	5	5-1/4
No. 1 picnic----	6-1/4	7	6	6-1/2

3.4 Determination of styles, types, sizes, drained weights. - Unless otherwise specified, the determination of styles, types, sizes, grades, and drained weights of canned asparagus shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Grades of Canned Asparagus (and lot inspection and certification tolerances applicable thereto as set forth in the Regulations Governing Inspection and Certification of Processed Fruits and Vegetables and Related Products).

3.4.1 Fancy (grade A). - Canned asparagus of this grade shall be practically free from defects, shall possess a good character, shall possess a good flavor; and, within the limits prescribed in the United States Standards for Grades of Canned Asparagus, shall possess a clear liquor and shall possess a good color.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Table III. - Minimum drained weight for style IV, cut spears (or cut stalks)

Container size or designation (metal, unless otherwise stated)	Style IV, cut spears (or cut stalks)	
	(a) Green	(b) Green-tipped and white
	Ounces	Ounces
8 oz. tall-------	4-3/4	5
8 oz. glass------	4-3/4	5
No. 1 picnic-----	6	6-1/2
12 Z-------------	7-1/4	7-3/4
No. 300----------	8-1/2	9
No. 300 x 409----	8-3/4	9-1/4
No. 300 cylinder-	------	-------
No. 1 tall-------	9-1/4	10-1/4
No. 303----------	9-1/4	10-1/4
No. 303 glass----	9-1/4	10-1/4
No. 2------------	11-3/4	12-3/4
No. 2-1/2--------	16-3/4	18-1/2
No. 2-1/2 glass--	16-3/4	18-1/2
No. 603 x 408----	38	42
No. 10-----------	60-1/4	64-1/2

3.4.2 Standard (grade C). - Canned asparagus of this grade shall possess a fairly clear liquor, shall possess a fairly good color, shall be fairly free from defects, shall possess a fairly good character, and shall possess a fairly good flavor.

3.5 Workmanship. - Canned asparagus shall be processed under sanitary conditions and in accordance with good commercial practice. The product shall be sufficiently processed by heat to assure preservation in hermetically-sealed containers, either tin or glass, as specified. Containers shall be sound and clean. Cans shall be free from rust and serious dents and the ends shall be flat or concave.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.1 Sampling. - Samples of finished products covered by this specification and samples of any materials, components or constituents entering into the preparation of the finished products may be taken at any time by the Government inspector to determine compliance with the requirements.

4.2 Inspection.

4.2.1 General. - Inspection shall be made by the procuring agency or a duly authorized representative at the time and place designated by the procuring agency. It may be made at the site of manufacture, both during and after processing, at any suitable point in transit, and/or after delivery to the point of destination.

4.2.2 Factory inspection. - The passing as satisfactory of any detail of processing or materials shall not relieve the contractor of responsibility for faulty workmanship or materials which may be discovered at any time prior to final acceptance.

4.2.3 Final inspection. - Unless otherwise specified, final inspection shall be made after delivery to the point of destination (see 6.4 and 6.5).

4.2.4 Condition inspection of containers. - When inspection of product for quality and condition is performed by the U. S. Department of Agriculture the 'Condition Inspection Procedures - Containers' pertaining to processed fruits and vegetables shall apply.

4.2.5 Responsibility for inspection. - The supplier is responsible for meeting all the provisions of the specification prior to submission of supplies to the Government for acceptance. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier is required to furnish an official inspection certificate issued by a Federal agency certifying that the grade of the product supplied is as required by the contract or order.

4.2.5.1 Inspection records of the examination and tests shall be complete and made available to the Government as specified in the contract or order. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 Tests. - Test procedures and controls which differ from those specified herein may be used by the contractor if they provide a quality assurance equivalent to that specified. If the Government inspection activity determines that such procedures and controls do not provide, as a minimum, such quality assurance, the contractor will use the test procedures set forth herein. In case of dispute as to test results, the test methods specified herein will govern.

4.3.2 Chemical analyses. - Unless otherwise specified, chemical analyses, if required by the purchaser, shall be made in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists in effect on the date of the invitation for bids or in accordance with methods that give equivalent results.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Product shall be packaged, packed and marked in conformance with the requirements of Interim Federal Specification PPP-C- for level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. - Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) The style and type of pack, size, and grade of product desired.
(b) Size and kind of packaging required, or levels of packaging as may be applicable.
(c) Level of packing as may be applicable.
(d) If "dietetic packs" are desired, the procurement documents should so specify.
(e) If USDA Certificate of Quality and Condition is desired the procurement documents should so specify.

6.2 This specification does not include all blends of sizes or types of canned asparagus that are commercially available but is intended to cover the products that are normally suitable for Federal Government requirements.

6.3 If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.4 Contractor's inspection. - The Contractor should be required to assure that the product conforms with the specification prior to submission to the Government for final inspection.

6.5 Destination inspection. - When the finished product has been inspected and passed at point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for condition and quantity only.

6.6 Level B packaging is intended to provide an economical but limited protection and should be specified only when it is determined that the product packaging provides protection against damage during multiple shipments in which shipping and handling will be under cover, and storage will be in warehouses or other structures providing equivalent protection from weather.

Notice: (SEE LAST PAGE)

Military Interests:

Army - QM
Navy - S MC
Air Force - MAAMA

☆ U. S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE: 1973-714-543/4241

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS ON OBTAINING COPIES OF FEDERAL SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, and Auburn, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

NOTICE

When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.